

Competitor name	Strengths	Weaknesses	Competition values	Opportunities
NotebookLM (Google)	• Source-grounded answers that cite the uploaded material • Generates quizzes, flashcards and audio overviews • Free tier and strong underlying models • Notebooks can be shared with classmates	• Sources must be uploaded into a notebook; it does not read local course folders • Cloud only — material leaves the device • No in-reader flow for the page a student is on • No review scheduled against exam dates • Notebook upkeep stays manual as the course goes on	• Free access and Google brand trust • Model quality and breadth of accepted source types • Study output (quiz, flashcards, audio) from material you supply	• Remove the upload step by working from course folders already on the device • Explain the page in front of the student rather than the notebook as a whole • Carry the same passage through to practice and planned review
Goodnotes AI	• Established iPad note and PDF app that students already own • AI questions across notes and PDFs, plus generated quizzes • Excellent handwriting and annotation experience • Already sits inside the student's study habit	• Notebook-centred rather than course-folder centred • Weaker desktop experience • Citations back to the source page are less rigorous • No course-wide review plan • Subscription pricing	• Ink and annotation quality on iPad • Incumbency — it is where the notes already live • Familiar student price point	• Desktop-first study sessions, iPad second • Explanations with a verifiable page reference • A complete study-to-review loop instead of separate per-notebook features
Adobe Acrobat AI Assistant	• Questions over any PDF with cited passages • Mobile app and voice input • Trusted PDF engine and broad institutional distribution	• Works per document, with no course-level view across many PDFs • Paid add-on on top of an existing subscription • No practice or retention features • Documents are processed in the cloud	• The PDF standard and the trust that comes with it • Enterprise and institutional reach • Citation accuracy within a single document	• Memory across every PDF in one course, not one file at a time • Practice and planned review after the explanation • Local file control as the stated default
General assistants (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini)	• Strongest explanation quality and voice conversation • File upload, and broad student adoption already • Usable free tiers	• Context must be set up by hand every session — the exact friction Linda described • No persistent tie to the student's own course files • No spaced review or retention tracking	• Model quality and a general-purpose habit • Brand recognition among students • Price — the free tier is good enough for many	• Sit on top of the same class of model as a study-specific layer: file-aware, page-anchored, retention-oriented • Compete on removing repeated context-setting rather than on raw answer quality

		• Uploads leave the device		
Anki and Quizlet	• Proven spaced repetition with real evidence for retention • Large libraries of shared decks • Free or low cost	• Cards are made by hand and disconnected from the source material • No explanation of the material being memorised • Card-making effort is why students abandon them mid-term	• Price and proven learning science • Community-contributed content • Cross-platform review on a phone	• Generate practice from the passage the student has just read • Schedule review automatically against exam dates • Remove the card-making cost that stops students using spaced repetition at all